AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University
Faculty of Language Studies

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

L201A
English in the World (I)
Main Exam
Final Exam

2024-2025 /Spring Semester
Date: 31 May 2025
1:00 – 4:00

Number of Exam Pages: 6 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

INSTRUCTION

1. Use answer booklet for your answers.
2. Clearly write the number of the question which you have decided to answer.
3. Use the overleaf for your drafts.
4. Choose 5 out of the 8 terms from Part A. Provide examples where appropriate.
5. Answer all questions in Part B
6. Choose 2 out of 3 essay questions from part C. Use an appropriate essay format with a good introduction and conclusion. The word count is 200 – 250 words.
7. Return this question sheet with your answer booklet. Note that any notes on the question sheet will not be considered when grading.

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Part A: (20 marks)

Choose **FIVE** of the terms listed below and provide short notes on the terms you choose (30-50 words). Provide illustrative examples, as relevant (4 points each: 2 for the explanation of the term and 2 for a correct example).

1) Colonisation
2) Settlement
3) Lingua Franca
4) Pidgin languages
5) Dialect levelling
6) Cultural homogeneity
7) Codeswitching
8) The Great Vowel Shift

Part B: (10 marks)

Multiple Choice Question (1 mark each)

1. Isoglosses are the geographical boundaries defining:
(A) Creole and Pidgin languages
(B) Particular linguistic features
(C) First and second languages
(D) Formal and informal varieties

2. Rhoticity is explained as
(A)The pronunciation of the "r" sound in certain dialects of English.
(B) The ability to distinguish between voiced and voiceless consonants.
(C)The use of nasal vowels in a language.
(D) The variation in the pitch of a language when spoken.

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3. A global language is a world language that is
(A) geographically widespread
(B) makes it possible for members of different language communities to communicate
(C) options A and B
(D) None of the above

4. The spread of English as a global language was caused by:
(A) social, political, economic and technological influences
B) Trade with China
C) Plantation Colonization
D) Simplicity of the language

5. What term refers to the process by which a pidgin language evolves into a more complex and stable language, often becoming a mother tongue for a community?
A) Pidginization
B) Creolization
C) Language Shift
D) Linguistic Imperialism

6. Inner Circle Englishes are spoken in
(A) England, Scotland, Wales, Ireland, North America, Australia and New Zealand
(B) India, Singapore, Malaysia and China
(C) South America, Australia and New Zealand
(D) Egypt, Jordan, Lebanon and the Gulf

7. What is the primary difference between a Pidgin and a Creole?
A) Pidgin is a natural language, while Creole is artificial
B) Pidgin is a simplified language, while Creole is a fully developed language
C) Pidgin has complex grammar, while Creole is simpler
D) Pidgin is spoken by all members of a community, while Creole is spoken by a few people

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8. Which of the following regions is associated with the "Outer Circle" in Kachru's model of World Englishes?

A) The United States
B) The United Kingdom
C) India
D) China

9. Which historical event is most closely associated with the spread of English across the globe?

A) The French Revolution
B) The Age of Exploration and Colonization
C) The Industrial Revolution
D) The Renaissance

10. The Great Vowel Shift, a significant phonological phenomenon in Middle English, primarily affected the pronunciation of which specific category of sounds, contributing to the transition from Middle English to Early Modern English?

A) Consonants
B) Vowels
C) Both consonants and vowels
D) None of the above

Part C: (20 marks)

Choose **TWO** questions to answer, using around 350 word per answer. (10 marks each)

Question C1: Explain the factors that have influenced the spread of English across the globe throughout the twentieth and early decades of the twenty-first centuries.

Question C2: How have different types of colonization affected the development of different varieties of English? Support your discussion with relevant examples.

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Question C3: Discuss the development of varieties of English in the inner, outer or expanding circles in relation to the historical, geographical and social contexts. Explain through appropriate examples.

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